

SCRIPTURE & REFLECTION JOURNAL

Brokenness — Session 1: Sin

PART 1 · WHAT IS SIN?

Romans 3:23 · 1 John 3:4

“For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.” “Everyone who sins breaks the law; in fact, sin is lawlessness.”

Q: Before tonight, how would you have defined sin in your own words?

James 4:17

If anyone, then, knows the good they ought to do and doesn't do it, it is sin for them.

Q: This includes failing to act, not just wrong action. Does that change how you think about your own life?

Genesis 3:1–6

“Did God really say...?” The serpent questioned, then distorted, God's word. Eve saw the fruit was good for food, pleasing to the eye, and desirable for gaining wisdom — so she took and ate, and gave some to Adam, who was with her.

Q: What's the first move the serpent makes — a question, or an action?

Q: Where has doubt about what God actually said been the opening move toward compromise in your life?

Romans 5:12

Just as sin entered the world through one man, and death through sin, and in this way death came to all people, because all sinned.

Q: What does it mean that sin ‘entered’ the world — as an invader, not something we were created with?

James 1:14–15

Each person is tempted when they are dragged away by their own evil desire and enticed. Then, after desire has conceived, it gives birth to sin...

Q: What's the difference between a thought that knocks and a thought we let in and feed?

Hebrews 4:15

For we do not have a high priest who is unable to empathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who has been tempted in every way, just as we are — yet he did not sin.

Q: Have I sinned simply because I was tempted?

Psalm 1:1

Blessed is the one who does not walk in step with the wicked or stand in the way that sinners take or sit in the company of mockers.

Q: Walk, stand, sit — where am I currently in this progression with something specific in my life?

Q: Think of something culturally common you were once uncomfortable with and now aren't. What changed — your convictions, or your exposure?

Hebrews 3:13

Encourage one another daily, as long as it is called ‘Today,’ so that none of you may be hardened by sin's deceitfulness.

Q: Where has sin told me ‘this is harmless,’ then ‘just once,’ then ‘this is just who I am’?

2 Samuel 11:2

One evening David got up from his bed and walked around on the roof of the palace. From the roof he saw a woman bathing. The woman was very beautiful...

Q: Where do I have an opportunity to stop — but haven't taken it?

Judges 16:20

...he did not know that the LORD had left him.

Q: Am I becoming numb to conviction in any area of my life?

1 Kings 11:4

As Solomon grew old, his wives turned his heart after other gods, and his heart was not fully devoted to the LORD his God.

Q: Where might my heart be slowly drifting, without one big decision behind it?

Q: Escalation (David), numbness (Samson), or drift (Solomon) — which most describes me right now?

Romans 7:15, 18

I do not understand what I do. For what I want to do I do not do, but what I hate I do... For I have the desire to do what is good, but I cannot carry it out.

Q: Where am I currently struggling — still fighting, still convicted — versus somewhere I may have quietly settled?

1 John 1:8–9

If we claim to be without sin, we deceive ourselves. If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness.

Q: What does this promise to someone who's honest about where they are?

Romans 2:15

They show that the requirements of the law are written on their hearts, their consciences also bearing witness, and their thoughts sometimes accusing them and at other times even defending them.

Q: Has my conscience ever gone quiet about something it used to flag? What happened in between?

1 Timothy 4:2

...through the hypocrisy of liars whose consciences have been seared as with a hot iron.

Q: Where might repetition have dulled an alarm in me that used to go off?

2 Corinthians 7:10

Godly sorrow brings repentance that leads to salvation and leaves no regret, but worldly sorrow brings death.

Q: When guilt shows up in my life, does it tend to drive me toward God, or away from Him?

Symptoms of a Heart Drifting

A boundary that used to feel firm now feels flexible. Content or company that once made you uncomfortable no longer does. You've started explaining a choice you used to just avoid. Conviction shows up less often. You've stopped bringing an area of your life into the light with anyone.

Q: Which of these, if any, do I recognize in myself right now?

1 Corinthians 6:18

Flee from sexual immorality. All other sins a person commits are outside the body, but whoever sins sexually, sins against their own body.

Q: Where do I need to flee rather than negotiate?

James 4:7

Submit yourselves, then, to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.

Q: What does resisting the devil look like for me this week?

Romans 13:14

Clothe yourselves with the Lord Jesus Christ, and do not think about how to gratify the desires of the flesh.

Q: What provision am I making for the flesh that I need to remove?

Proverbs 4:23

Above all else, guard your heart, for everything you do flows from it.

Q: What am I doing to guard my heart above everything else?

James 5:16

Confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed.

Q: Who can I bring this into the light with this week, so it doesn't stay invisible?

BRING IT HOME

Bring It Home

Sometimes the most important question is not 'How far have I fallen?' but 'Which direction am I walking?'

Q: Where does my compromise usually begin?

Q: What have I normalized that once convicted me?

Q: Am I currently walking, standing, or sitting in an area I know I shouldn't be?

Q: Is what I'm feeling right now conviction, or shame?
